

FIFA WORLD CUP

FIVE-YEAR PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS

(2002-2018)

Prepared by: Olukotun Damilola Esther
Role: Data Analyst

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Executive Summary

This report presents a five-year performance analysis of the FIFA World Cup, covering the 2002, 2006, 2010, 2014, and 2018 tournaments. The objective was to consolidate results from all five tournaments, identify performance leaders and laggards across a range of metrics, and surface tailored insights requested by the business including scoring trends, France's tournament history, and Nigeria's five-year record.

Across the five tournaments analyzed, 59 countries made at least one appearance, playing a combined 640 games that produced 793 goals. Germany emerged as the standout performer of the period, leading the field in games played, wins, goals scored, goal difference, and total points. At the other end of the table, Angola and China PR recorded some of the weakest returns, each managing very limited output across their appearances.

The analysis also confirms a story familiar to football followers: France's 2018 campaign — the year they lifted the trophy — was comfortably their strongest of the five tournaments studied, while Nigeria failed to progress beyond the group stage in any of their four appearances in this period.

1. Introduction

The FIFA World Cup is the world's most-watched single-sport tournament, contested every four years by the senior men's national teams affiliated with FIFA. Since the inaugural 1930 tournament, the competition has been held 21 times, interrupted only by the Second World War in 1942 and 1946. Twenty-one tournaments have produced eight different champions: Brazil (5 titles), Germany and Italy (4 each), Argentina, France, and Uruguay (2 each), and England and Spain (1 each).

This report was commissioned to support Super Sport Gaming Co.'s content and product strategy with a data-driven view of recent World Cup history. The scope is limited to the five most recent completed tournaments 2002 through 2018 giving a 16-year window of team-level performance data.

2. Methodology

2.1 Data Source

Five source files were provided, one per tournament (2002, 2006, 2010, 2014, 2018), each listing every participating country's final tournament record: games played, wins, draws, losses, goals for, goals against, goal difference, and points.

2.2 Data Preparation

- Each of the five tournament files was individually cleaned and validated for correct data types.
- A Year field was added to each table to preserve tournament identity after combining.
- The five tables were appended into a single consolidated fact table of 160 team-tournament records.

- A data-quality issue was identified and corrected: the Goal Difference column used a non-standard Unicode minus character for negative values, which was normalized to ensure correct numeric aggregation.
- Two supporting dimension tables were derived from the consolidated data: a distinct list of the 59 participating countries, and a distinct list of the 5 tournament years.

2.3 Analytical Approach

A star-schema data model (one fact table, two dimension table) was built to support flexible slicing by team and by year. Aggregate measures totals, rates, and highest/lowest lookups were then computed across the combined dataset to answer both the general performance questions and the tailored business questions set out in the case study brief.

3. General Findings

3.1 Participation

A total of 59 countries played in at least one of the five tournaments studied.

Metric	Result
Countries that played (2002–2018)	59
Countries with the most appearances (5 of 5)	Argentina, Brazil, England, France, Germany, Japan, Mexico, Portugal, South Korea, Spain
Countries with the fewest appearances (1 of 5)	18 countries, including Angola, China PR, New Zealand, Togo

3.2 Combined Totals (All 59 Countries, All 5 Tournaments)

Metric	Total
Games Played	640
Games Won	247
Games Drawn	146
Games Lost	247
Goals For	793
Goals Against	793
Total Points	887

Note: totals for games played, wins, and losses are naturally double-counted at the tournament level (each match involves two teams), which is why wins and losses both equal 247 and goals for/against both equal 793.

3.3 Highest & Lowest by Metric (Combined 5 Year Totals)

Metric	Highest	Value	Lowest	Value
Games Played	Germany	31	Angola	3
Games Won	Germany	22	Angola	0
Games Lost	South Korea	9	New Zealand	0
Goals For	Germany	64	China PR	0
Goals Against	Brazil	27	Angola	2
Goal Difference	Germany	42	Saudi Arabia	−22
Points	Germany	69	China PR	0

Germany's dominance across almost every category reflects a run of strong tournaments across this period, including their 2014 title win. China PR's zero points and zero goals reflect a single, difficult 2002 campaign in which they lost all three group matches without scoring.

4. Tailored Analysis

4.1 Goal-Scoring Trend, 2002–2018

Year	Total Goals Scored
2002	161
2006	147
2010	145
2014	171
2018	169

Goal-scoring dipped from 161 in 2002 to a low of 145 in 2010, before recovering to its highest level of the period in 2014 (171 goals) and remaining strong in 2018 (169 goals). The overall pattern suggests a more attacking, higher-scoring era in the two most recent tournaments studied compared with the mid-2000s.

4.2 France: Year-by-Year Performance

Year	Games	Wins	Draws	Losses	Goals For	Goals Against	Points
2002	3	0	1	2	0	3	1
2006	7	4	3	0	9	3	15
2010	3	0	1	2	1	4	1
2014	5	3	1	1	10	3	10
2018	7	6	1	0	14	6	19

France's best year across every measure studied (points, goals, and wins) was 2018 (19 points, 14 goals, 6 wins), the tournament they went on to win. Their weakest years were 2002 and 2010, each ending with a single point and an early group-stage exit. The trend line across the five tournaments shows a broadly upward trajectory in win count and points, with 2006 as a strong secondary peak (a tournament in which France reached the final).

4.3 Goal Difference: Best and Worst Performers

Rank	Top 5 Goal Difference	Value	Rank	Bottom 5 Goal Difference	Value
1	Germany	+42	1	Saudi Arabia	-22
2	Brazil	+29	2	Australia	-13
3	Netherlands	+18	3	Cameroon	-12
4	France	+15	4	North Korea	-11
5	Spain	+14	5	Honduras	-10

Germany's 42 combined goal difference is the widest margin of any country in the study, roughly 45% higher than second-placed Brazil (+29). Saudi Arabia's -22 stands out as the weakest goal difference recorded, driven substantially by their 8–0 defeat to Germany in the 2002 tournament.

4.4 Nigeria: Five-Year Performance

Year	Games	Wins	Draws	Losses	Goals For	Goals Against	Goal Diff.	Points
2002	3	0	1	2	1	3	-2	1
2006	Did not qualify	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2010	3	0	1	2	3	5	-2	1
2014	4	1	1	2	3	5	-2	4
2018	3	1	0	2	3	4	-1	3

Nigeria appeared in four of the five tournaments studied, failing to qualify for 2006. Across those four appearances, Nigeria never recorded a positive goal difference and never advanced beyond the group stage. Their strongest showing by points was 2014 (4 points from a win and a draw), narrowly the best of their four campaigns, though still insufficient for knockout-stage qualification.

5. Conclusion & Recommendations

The five tournaments studied show Germany as the era's most consistently dominant footballing nation by the numbers, while a core group of ten countries including Brazil, France, Spain, and England have qualified for every tournament in the period, reflecting sustained footballing strength. Goal-scoring has

trended upward in the two most recent tournaments, suggesting a shift toward more attacking play or more permissive officiating in this window.

- For content strategy, Germany, Brazil, and France's tournament histories offer the richest storytelling material given their consistent high performance.
- Nigeria's four-tournament record, while not competitively strong, may still resonate with the Nigerian market specifically and could support regionally-targeted content.
- The rising goal-scoring trend from 2010 onward is worth monitoring in future tournaments to see whether it continues, which would inform expectations for upcoming competitions.

A companion Data Dictionary document accompanies this report, detailing every field in the underlying dataset, and a PowerPoint summary has been prepared for stakeholder presentation.

Appendix: Interactive Power BI Dashboard

The findings in this report are drawn from an interactive Power BI dashboard built on a star-schema data model (Facts_Results, Teams, Years). The dashboard spans four pages, shown below, and allows a viewer to filter by tournament year and by country.

A.1 Home



Figure A.1 — Dashboard landing page with navigation to Overview, Country Performance, and Tournament Comparative Analysis.

A.2 Overview

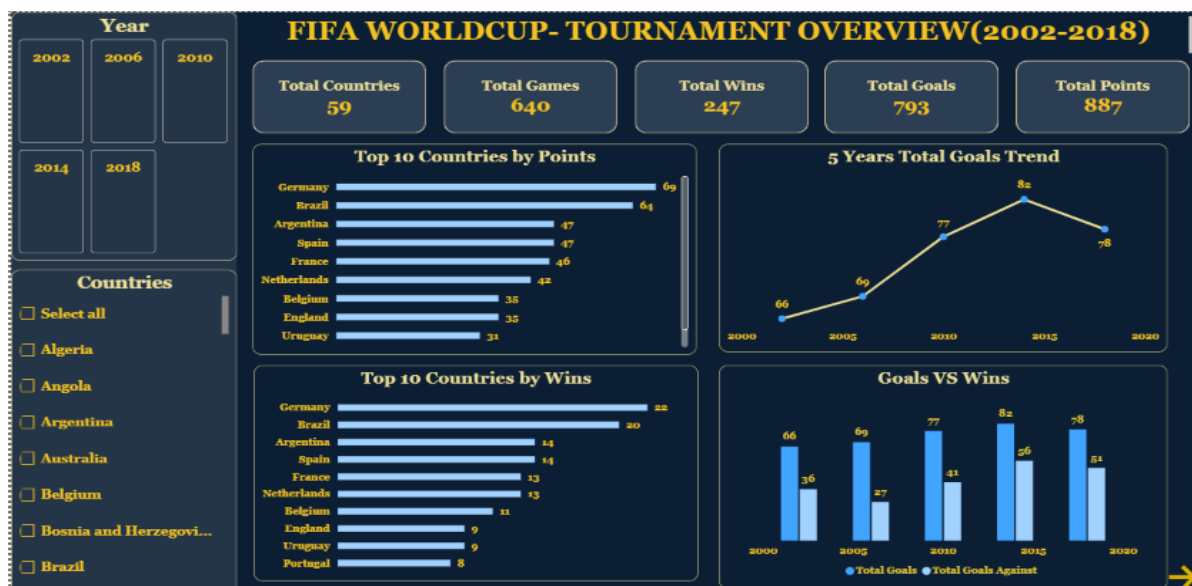


Figure A.2 — Overview page: combined 5-year KPIs, top-10 countries by points and wins, and the 5-year goals trend.

A.3 Country Performance

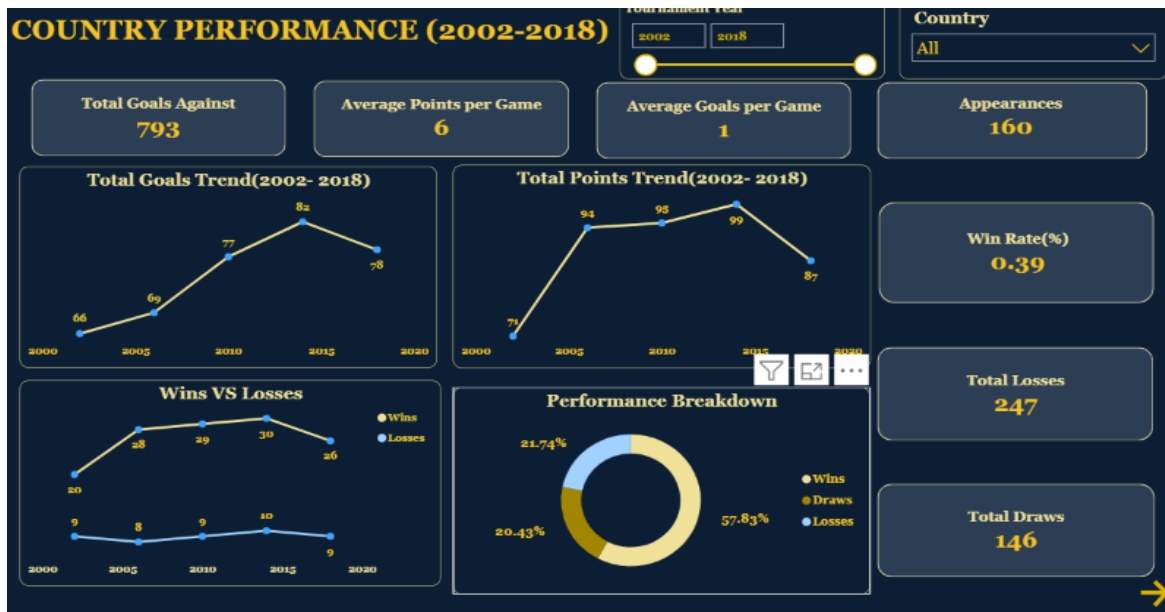


Figure A.3 — Country Performance page: goals and points trend lines, win/loss trend, and win/draw/loss breakdown, filterable by year and country.

A.4 Tournament Comparative Analysis



Figure A.4 — Tournament Comparative Analysis page: full country-by-country results table, goal-difference chart, and the highest/lowest metric lookup table.